advocacy groups, and other stakeholders to mobilize and campaign for continued membership, exerting pressure on governments to reverse course. Additionally, this buffer period allows time for political shifts, potentially ushering in leadership more favorable to the IO before the withdrawal process is finalized.

Beyond procedural delays, IOs can also raise the stakes for exit by introducing tangible penalties for treaty violations or withdrawals. Sanctions tied to treaty compliance serve as a powerful deterrent. For example, in its 1990 preferential trade agreement with the EU, Chile agreed to a clause permitting the EU to impose sanctions in the event of human-rights violations or democratic backsliding (Hafner-Burton 2011). This type of automatic punitive mechanism could be adapted to modern IOs, providing clear and enforceable consequences for countries that choose to sever their commitments. By embedding such clauses into agreements, IOs not only heighten the cost of disengagement but also signal their seriousness about upholding collective values and rules.

These measures, individually and collectively, help fortify IOs against populist-driven attempts to undermine multilateral cooperation. By increasing the procedural and material costs of exit, IOs can foster greater stability and commitment among member states, safeguarding the integrity and longevity of the international system.

REDUCING BARRIERS TO RE-ENTRY

IOs can further strengthen their resilience by reducing barriers to re-entry and re-engagement, making it easier for states to rejoin after a populist-led withdrawal. When countries formally exit an IO, rejoining often requires meeting stringent accession criteria, even if a more cooperative political environment emerges. By streamlining re-entry processes, IOs can diminish concerns about prolonged or permanent disengagement, ultimately reducing the risks and costs associated with sidelining hostile states.

Some IOs have already embraced flexible re-entry mechanisms, ensuring that states can return with minimal disruption. For instance, the Paris Agreement features a re-entry process that enabled the United States to rejoin swiftly under the Biden administration. This design reflects a conscious effort to foster continued global participation and minimize